

whatweretheythinking.com



Some say, it's impossible to foretell death, some say, it's not. Some don't give a hoot about kicking the bucket, while some freeze at its thought. Here's a Web site that actually tells you when you are going to die—exactly when! As you visit www.deathclock.com, you will be greeted with the punchline—“Death Clock: The Internet's friendly reminder that life is slipping away...”

An info box, laid out with utmost matter-of-factness, asks for your date of birth, sex, and whether you are a pessimist, optimist, sadist, and what not. That's not it. It has something called a body-mass index, which is calculated using your height and weight. Deadly jargon, eh? After this ludicrous round of inputs, hit the blood-red ‘Check your Death Clock’ button. And Voila!—the exact date of your looming death!

Don't waste time in trying to get over the shock—the's work to be done. A Deathclock poll invites you to cast your vote on exactly how you think you are going to die! Deadly democracy, isn't it? Draft your Will, or take your time and compose that last prayer. And have faith people, a section actually helps you postpone your death, with the perfect recipe to boost your longevity!

While you keep rummaging Deathclock to find out how to die another day, we try to figure out why on earth they made such a site. Chances for both are dead as a dodo. Woody Allen's famous confession keeps haunting—“It's not that I am scared of death. I just don't want to be there when it happens.”

breakable. No Internet transaction would be safe.”

So what is the Riemann hypothesis? It's too complex to explain in its entirety here, but in essence, proving it would explain the seemingly random pattern of the sequence of prime numbers. And prime numbers are at the root of cryptography, and hence, security of transactions on the Internet and elsewhere.

What has happened is that this year, Louis de Branges, a French-born mathematician at Purdue University, claimed a proof of the Riemann hypothesis. His colleagues have remained unconvinced thus far, and the mathematical community is sceptical.

Prof Marcus du Sautoy of the Oxford University explains, “The whole of e-commerce depends on prime numbers. I have described the primes as atoms: what mathematicians are missing is a kind of mathematical prime spectrometer. If the Riemann hypothesis is true,



it won't produce a prime number spectrometer. But the proof should give us more understanding of how the primes work, and therefore the proof might be translated into something that might produce this prime spectrometer. If it does, it will bring the whole of e-commerce to its knees, overnight. So there are very big implications.” ☐

Blog WATCH

Here's taking a look at a few riveting posts from the world of blogs. This month, we examine a discussion on the VoIP revolution, across the globe. More on spam—why online newspapers require registration, the new face of cyber crime, and why spamming is “the online equivalent of the teenagers who drive around smashing mailboxes.”

Om Malik on Broadband

http://www.gigaom.com/2004/09/the_voice_over_i.php

The Voice over IP Insurrection

The VoIP insurrection over the last decade marks a milestone in communication history no less dramatic than the arrival of the telephone in 1876. We know data networks and packetized voice will displace the long standing pre-1995 world rooted in Alexander Graham Bell's invention. It remains uncertain whether telecom's incumbent carriers and equipment makers will continue to dominate or even survive as the information technology industry absorbs voice as a simple application of the Internet.

Mike

<http://www.techdirt.com/>

Why Online Newspapers Require Registration

The main reason most sites require registration: spam. Direct mail marketing companies are offering ridiculous (\$300 CPM) fees for email lists of registered newspaper readers for spam purposes.

Never mind the fact that many of those email addresses are bogus dirty data, the newspapers see cash from spam. This isn't, as they claim, about having more detailed demographic info to “more accurately target advertising,” but about having your email address to sell to spammers. Once again, BugMeNot becomes a useful anti-spam tool. It seems hard to believe selling email addresses to spammers could be a successful long-term business strategy.

JC (Knight)

<http://www.seoachat.com/showblog/282/The-new-face-of-cybercrime>

The New Face of Cybercrime

Today's hacker isn't just out to show off, they're just in it for the \$\$\$\$. Read the ‘full story’ for a very insightful look into today's state of affairs, and the means necessary for protection.

[Reference URL: <http://news.com.com/2010-1029-5275150.html?tag=nefd.acpro>]

Most spammers want to “phish” your credit card number. Messages now zip around the Internet purporting to come from trusted companies and asking you to “verify your account.” This is the new face of cybercrime.

Alex D

<http://killthespam.blogspot.com/>

Respect and the Internet

On television, in print, or on the radio, ads disguised to look like an emergency warning would be pulled immediately. Why is this practice permitted online?

We humans have turned the world of computers into virtual living. As a computer operates like an individual mind, the Internet mimics the global community.

When you are online, you are virtually taking a walk down the street. Entering a site is like being welcomed as a guest into another person's house. If you're rude and attempt to start disrespectful arguments or fights, the owner has the right to throw you out and repair damage.